



**COLT SECOND MODEL
DRAGOON REVOLVER, 1849**



**COLT NAVY MODEL
1861 REVOLVER**



COLT M1911A1

- 1836** Samuel Colt founds his first company for firearms production.
- 1847** Colt produces the Walker Colt revolver with Samuel Hilton Walker.
- 1848** The Colt Dragoon revolver is introduced, initially for the US Army's Mounted Rifles.
- 1851** Colt opens a factory in England, increasing access to international markets.
- 1855** Colt incorporates the Colt's Patent Fire Arms

Manufacturing Company, based at his newly built Connecticut factory.

- 1861** The Colt Navy Revolver is introduced and quickly sees service in the American Civil War.
- 1863** The Colt Single Action Army Model is introduced. Long-barreled versions produced in 1876 become known as "Buntline Specials," after a legend that author Ned Buntline presented them to lawmen, including Wyatt Earp.

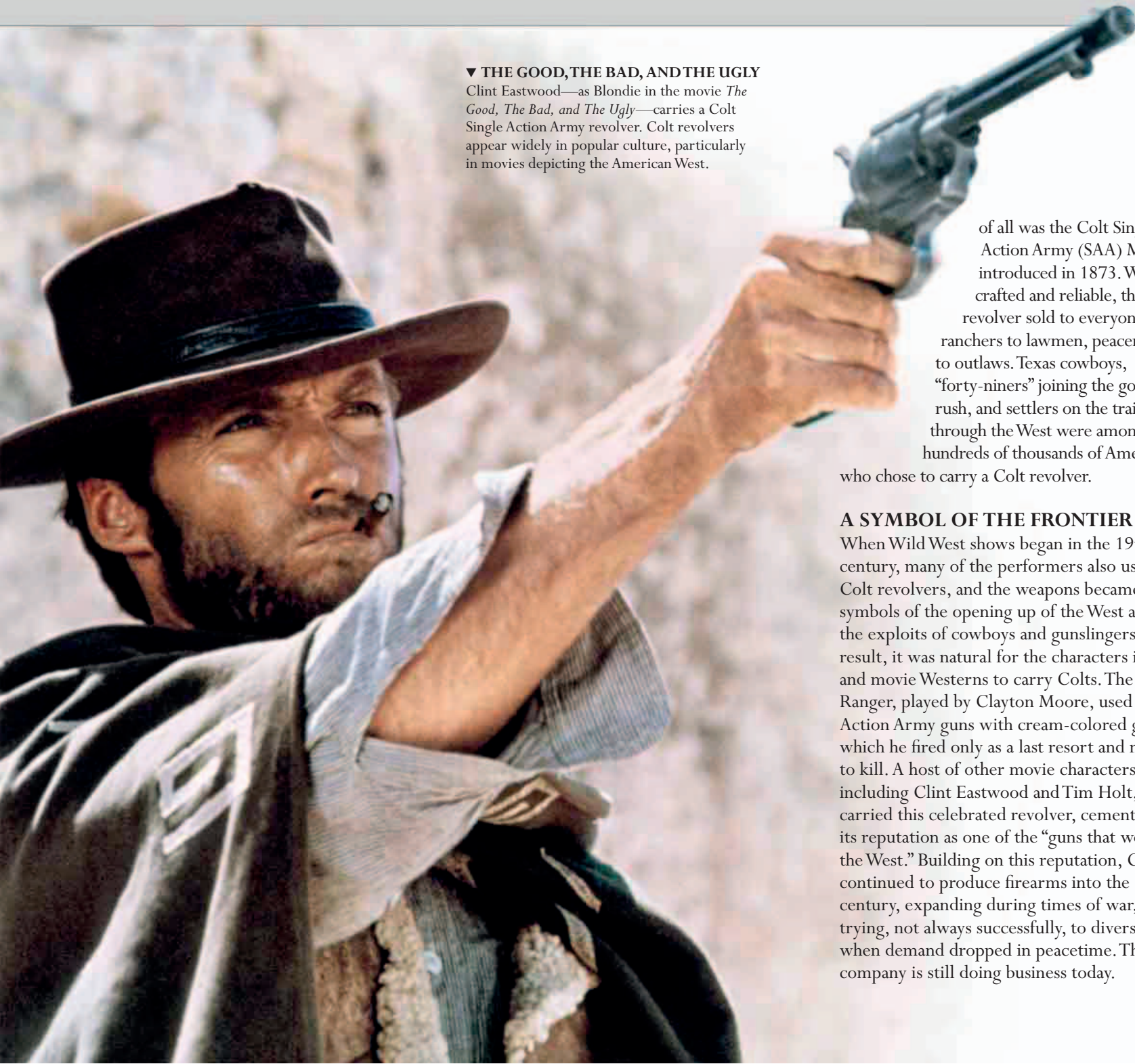
- 1900** Colt becomes the first American manufacturer of automatic pistols.

- 1911** Browning designs the Colt M1911, which is adopted by the US Army. In 1924, it is modified into the M1911A1.

- 1994** After a difficult period involving bankruptcy proceedings, the Colt company is bought by new investors and begins a recovery.

▼ THE GOOD, THE BAD, AND THE UGLY

Clint Eastwood—as Blondie in the movie *The Good, The Bad, and The Ugly*—carries a Colt Single Action Army revolver. Colt revolvers appear widely in popular culture, particularly in movies depicting the American West.



of all was the Colt Single Action Army (SAA) Model, introduced in 1873. Well crafted and reliable, this revolver sold to everyone from ranchers to lawmen, peacemakers to outlaws. Texas cowboys, "forty-niners" joining the gold rush, and settlers on the trail through the West were among the hundreds of thousands of Americans who chose to carry a Colt revolver.

A SYMBOL OF THE FRONTIER

When Wild West shows began in the 19th century, many of the performers also used Colt revolvers, and the weapons became symbols of the opening up of the West and the exploits of cowboys and gunslingers. As a result, it was natural for the characters in TV and movie Westerns to carry Colts. The Lone Ranger, played by Clayton Moore, used Single Action Army guns with cream-colored grips, which he fired only as a last resort and never to kill. A host of other movie characters, including Clint Eastwood and Tim Holt, carried this celebrated revolver, cementing its reputation as one of the "guns that won the West." Building on this reputation, Colt continued to produce firearms into the 20th century, expanding during times of war, and trying, not always successfully, to diversify when demand dropped in peacetime. The company is still doing business today.